



6th Grade English Language Arts

M/J Language Arts 1 (Florida course 1001010) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · Adventure, heroism, and happiness: from St. George to Shakespeare

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

6th Grade ELA follows a year of quests: a series of novels from the Roman Empire to Arthurian legend, joined by short stories, poetry, and Shakespeare retold. Uniting the texts is the theme of adventure, heroism, and happiness. Scholars examine where self-fulfillment and self-sacrifice meet, dive into the difficult questions their heroes face, and trace how characters are transformed by their adventures. Along the way they read closely, keep an ePortfolio journal, write narrations and imitations, complete grammar and vocabulary lessons aligned to Florida standards, and finish each module with a rhetorical project. VR experiences based on each module's literature and writing objectives run throughout the year.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 6 MODULES · 32 WEEKS

Module · Text	Weeks	Quarter	Focus & module project
1 · <i>St. George and the Dragon</i>	6	Q1	Setting, character motivation, symbolism, heroism, and what changes a character; project: VR Time Capsule with Letter
2 · <i>Poetry & Short Story</i> — Nash, Thomas, Hawthorne	4	Q1–Q2	"The Tale of Custard the Dragon," "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night," "The Golden Touch"; reading aloud, annotating, writing an original poem; project: "Dear Author, I Disagree" letter
3 · <i>King Arthur and His Knights</i> — Roger Lancelyn Green	6	Q2	Destiny and leadership, honor and loyalty tested, the symbolism of quests, betrayal and downfall; project: Family Shield
4 · <i>The Adventures of Robin Hood</i> — Roger Lancelyn Green	8	Q3	Becoming an outlaw, justice and ethical decisions, leadership and legacy; narrative essay
5 · <i>The Bronze Bow</i> — Elizabeth George Speare	5	Q4	Hatred and hope, family and faith, transformation and sacrifice in Roman-occupied Galilee; expository essay: "The Power of Choice: Daniel's Journey"
6 · <i>Shakespeare Stories</i> — Lamb retellings	3	Q4	<i>The Tempest</i> and <i>Much Ado About Nothing</i> ; betrayal, forgiveness, deception, redemption; final comparative essay

A TYPICAL WEEK

Strand	What the scholar does (~50 min/day, M–F)
Listen	The week opens with a Monday Recap Podcast from the teacher.
Read	The week's chapters, with a stated discussion focus (e.g., "honor and loyalty tested").
Write	ePortfolio journal entries , written narrations and imitations, and letters that build toward the module project.
VR	Grammar, writing, and vocabulary workshops in VR, plus a Friday storyboard activity on Optima's VR campus.
Project	Each module closes with a project week : time capsule, letter, shield, or essay.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. Reading and the weekly writing are the core of that time. **Project weeks** can run longer, and slower readers should budget extra time for *Robin Hood* and *The Bronze Bow*.

GRADING AT A GLANCE

Category	Weight	Includes
Assessments / Writing	35%	Essays, quizzes, written responses
Homework / Classwork	30%	Journals, reading work, grammar and vocabulary
Projects	20%	Module projects (time capsule, letter, shield, essays)
Performance / Participation	15%	Reading aloud, recordings, engagement

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ Copies of the module books (the teacher's section confirms editions and provided readings; poems and stories are provided in the lessons)
- ▶ Notebooks, binders, pens and pencils
- ▶ A computer with a web browser and a **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus

THE WRITING JOURNEY

- ▶ Narration and imitation first: retelling chapters, writing a poem in an author's pattern
- ▶ Rhetorical refutation: a respectful letter disagreeing with an author
- ▶ Then the longer forms: a narrative essay, an expository essay, and a final comparative essay

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study: assignments open at the start of each quarter and close at its end, with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.